The 1812 War

At the time of the Louisiana Purchase, as it is now known, America and Britain were locked in yet another conflict. The British had blocked the ports against Napolean and consequently ensured that the Americans could not deliver their goods. To add to the rising tension, British forces arrested deserters on Americans ships, some of whom were not considered to be deserters by the Americans. Furthermore, America was eyeing the region to the north and wished to invade Canada. The Congress officially supported the invasion but not everyone in the public realm provided their support. It was ultimately a divided country that led to the failure of the incursion.

Napoleon was abdicated in 1814 and the British were able to send more soldiers to America. The soldiers captured Washington in the same year but were forced to retreat within a couple of weeks. A peace treaty was drawn up and signed later that year.